

rely on corrupt politicians like Shibu Soren and Lalu Yadav for the survival of his Government, then the situation cannot be more grim than this.

BAL GOVIND, *Noida*

Foreign Hand

We recognise that we have endemic problems with our higher education system ("Degrees of Debate", May 10). But allowing the top foreign universities to set up shop in India is not the solution. While studying in overseas campuses, one is exposed to local cultures. It also enhances the student's ability to work with others. These character-building traits would get diluted when these campuses start operating in the country, due to societal and political influences as we know it. They will end up attracting many of the top existing faculties by offering higher emoluments and potentially greater opportunities for international research.

SURESH N. KARKHANIS, *Pune*

Slog Fest

The IPL sleaze has indeed been all-pervading and appears to have engulfed almost everybody who officially matters in the scheme of things ("The Slog Overs", May 10). The accountability though lies squarely with the IPL's celebrity Governing Council. The moot point is: was the payment of fat pay cheques to the Council

members an indication for them to turn a blind eye to Modi's manoeuvrings?

Poor Shashi Tharoor tried to join the party or so it seemed. If so, he certainly proved to be a novice in sleaze crisis management.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Against the Grain

Aatish Taseer's review of the book *Quarantine* is unkind ("Inverted Sexuality", May 3). This may mean Taseer's objective is achieved. It is, however, stupefying to see a

by taking a politically incorrect stance in our times. When read out of the context, Taseer's criticism seems quite unfounded, leading one to ask: So what?

ASHA HARIHARAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

Ebbing Flood

Apart from the factors listed for the increasing cost of milk, population growth and rising trend among urban women substituting breast milk with cow's milk are also im-

BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



“One of the reasons for ageing young is the availability of comfort. If youngsters exercise regularly, problems like arthritis will not occur.”

S. BALACHANDRAN, *Mumbai*

writer with two books to his credit taking on another incipient novelist and tearing him apart on every single account without any grace, denigrating the editor's rationale (so how was Taseer chosen to be published?), besides implicitly slamming the very premise of the book

portant ("White Crisis", May 3). Unfortunately, inadequacy and misutilisation of loans given for milch animal purchase have staggered the expansion of cattle numbers, which explains the increase in the price of milk.

R. THIRUNARAYANAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

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JULY 16-31, 1980

The Elusive Formula

The 10-month long Assam movement against "foreign" nationals is in a transitional stage. The people concerned, including the All Assam Students' Union (AASU) and All Assam Gana Sangram Parishad (AAGSP), are shifting stands—and so is the Centre. The veneer of non-violence is peeling off even faster than was expected. Despite well-meaning hopes of bureaucrats and the country's assorted Gandhites, the angry young men of the AASU and the equally angry but middle-aged men of the AAGSP could be roped in a palaver of sorts. It is clear now that the area of disagreements is too wide for talks. "The tiger and the deer do not talk," said an analyst in Shillong succinctly. As far as the Centre is concerned, two rival philosophies—often working at cross purposes—are emerging over Assam. Mrs Gandhi is perhaps trying both of these out, with the result that she has been able to achieve a perfect stasis. **by Sumit Mitra**



MRS GANDHI WITH AN ASSAM MINORITIES DELEGATION